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Functional Skills Level 1 English Writing Sample Paper 2

Worked Example – good pass

Candidate Name: Master Functional Skills | **Enrolment No: MFS4748**

Centre Name: Master Functional Skills | Centre Number: MFS0001

Candidate Signature: Master Functional Skills | Assessment Date: 20/10/2026

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- Assessment: Sample Paper 2 (Exemplar Benchmarks: Good · Borderline · Fail)
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Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – good Pass

Question 1

You witnessed a minor accident where a cyclist crashed into a pedestrian who was crossing the road. No one was seriously hurt, but the cyclist and the pedestrian had an argument about whose fault it was, which ended up with the police being called.

As you witnessed the whole event, the police have asked you to provide written details of what you saw.

Your task: write the narrative (sequence of events) of what happened. Include the following detail:

- where and when the accident took place
- what happened to cause the accident
- whose fault you believe it was
- what happened during the argument.

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

Witness report

Name of witness: Mrs S Barry
Address: 21 Howard Road, Stotford, ST3 6HY
Date of the accident: 06th July
Where the accident happened: Forest Road

On the 6th of July I was waiting to cross Forest road on the zebra crossing close to the junction with Stechford road when a man walked past me and steped straight out on to the zebra crossing. He was looking at his phone and did not look to see if any traffic was coming. A cyclist was coming up to the zebra crossing at the same moment and it was obvious that he was not planning to stop to let us cross so he crashed into the man who was crossing.

I don’t know whos fault it was because traffic should give way to people waiting to cross at a zebra crossing but you should always look before you step into the road. Both the cyclist and the man crossing didnt do what they was supposed to do.

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – good Pass

Both men ended up on the floor and they seemed to be a bit shaken. They started to shout at each other and were saying that it was the other persons fault. The cyclist was really angry and was pushing the other man around until someone stepped in to calm them down. Then the police arrived and separated the men.

Signed: S Barry

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing	✓				
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language	✓				
Overall band	Band 4				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	15

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling	4					
Punctuation			2			
Grammar	4					
SPaG Total						10
SPaG mark + composition mark						25

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – good Pass

Commentary

Composition

This is a very good statement that presents the information in a clear and coherent fashion, with very few errors. All the relevant detail is covered, and the layout and structure are appropriate to the task and audience. The vast majority of sentences are accurate, and the response includes good use of complex sentences.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling is very good, with only two errors. Sentence demarcation is accurate, but there are some missing commas and apostrophes and a lower case letter has been used for proper nouns. Grammar is also strong, with very few errors.

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – good Pass

Question 2

You would like to raise money for your favourite charity and have the idea of holding a sponsored silence for a whole afternoon.

Your task: write an email to a friend explaining your idea and asking them to help organise it.

Include the following detail:

- why you are writing
- what your idea is and how you think the event should be organised
- what the charity is and what they do
- what tasks you would like your friend to do to help.

Your friend's email address is j250@hotmail.com

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

To:	j250@hotmail.com
Cc:	
Subject:	Sponsored Silence!

Hi Justine

I have been thinking about our chat about raising some money for Mind and I think I have a great idea. How about a sponsored silence? You know how nioisy college can be at lunchtime so what if we organised a sponsored silence, and asked our whole course to get involved.

I dont think it would take too much organising really. All we would have to do is ask permition and then set up some tables and chairs in the hall for people to sit at. We would need someone to be the judge to make sure people were silent and it could run between 12 and 2 in the afternoon.

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – good Pass

The people who are taking part would need to get sponsored and they could ask there friend's and family to sponsor them. If everyone raised £10 and everyone from the course was envolved we would raise over £200 which would be brilliant.

I you wanted you could be the judge on the day and all you would have to do is sit there and check that everyone was silent. If someone made too much noise you would have to ask them to leave and make a note of how long they lasted. You would need paper, a pen, a watch and maybe a sign to show if someone has made too much noise.

Mind is a fantasic charity, they help people with their mental health. I think it would be good to raise money for them but if you would preferr to raise it for a diffrent charity we could do that too.

Hope you want to help

Lots of Love

Dannii

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – good Pass

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing	✓				
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language	✓				
Overall band	Band 4				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	15

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling		3				
Punctuation			2			
Grammar	4					
SPaG Total						9
SPaG mark + composition mark						24

Overall mark for question 2	25
Overall mark for question 1	24
FINAL MARK	49

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – good Pass

[GOOD PASS]

Commentary

Composition

This is a strong response that covers all the required detail and is very effective in getting its message across with clarity and coherence. All the required elements of an email are present, including an appropriate valediction and the sender's name. Sentence structures are varied and include complex sentences which, in the majority of cases, are accurately formed.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling is largely accurate although there are some errors: *noisy; permission; involved; fantastic; prefer; different.*

Punctuation is accurate most of the time, and there is good evidence of the use of commas to separate items in a list. Errors include a missing question mark, missing apostrophes, incorrect use of an apostrophe, omitted commas to separate clauses and a comma splice.

Grammar is very strong.

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Question 1

You witnessed a minor accident where a cyclist crashed into a pedestrian who was crossing the road. No one was seriously hurt, but the cyclist and the pedestrian had an argument about whose fault it was, which ended up with the police being called.

As you witnessed the whole event, the police have asked you to provide written details of what you saw.

Your task: write the narrative (sequence of events) of what happened. Include the following detail:

- where and when the accident took place
- what happened to cause the accident
- whose fault you believe it was
- what happened during the argument.

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

I was waiting to cross the road an a cyclist was coming a long when this bloke just step out into the road and the ciclyst tried to miss him but couldnt. The bloke fell down and ciclyst fell of his bike and landed in the road and a car that was behind him only just miss him. The man who walk into the road didn't look before he step out and I think he had his head phones in so he couldnt hear any thing either. It was definate his fault because he didn't look before he step out. They was both not badly hurt but they started an argument about who fault it was an it kicked of. they was just shouting and swearing at each other. I think the ciclyst called the police. When they was waiting for the police they still keep shouting and the bloke who step in the road was saying his phone was broken and the other man pays for it. The other man told him it was his own fault and they had a little fight but that didn't last long because I step in and stop it and then the police arrived.

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length		✓			
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing				✓	
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language		✓			
Overall band	Band 3				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	10

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling			2			
Punctuation				1		
Grammar			2			
SPaG Total						5
SPaG mark + composition mark						15

Commentary

Composition

The candidate has addressed the task and has written a sequential account of what was witnessed. The response is functional as the information is clear and coherent and relates the majority of what occurred in a way that could be understood by the reader. Three of the bullet points outlining the detail required have been covered, but the first bullet point has not been covered at all. What is written is clear and coherent and the language and register are mostly appropriate, only occasionally becoming too colloquial. Whilst it wouldn't be expected for a candidate to know how to formally lay out a witness statement, this response would have benefitted from a title and paragraphing as a minimum.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Spelling is correct most of the time, but errors include *and, along, cyclist, off, anything, headphone, definite*.

Punctuation consists mainly of correct sentence demarcation using capital letters and full stops, although there is one sentence that starts with a lower case letter. There is very little evidence of other types of punctuation. Apostrophes and commas are regularly omitted.

Grammar

There are several errors regarding verb-tense agreement and subject-verb agreement. Occasional articles are also omitted.

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Question 2

You would like to raise money for your favourite charity and have the idea of holding a sponsored silence for a whole afternoon.

Your task: write an email to a friend explaining your idea and asking them to help organise it.

Include the following detail:

- why you are writing
- what your idea is and how you think the event should be organised
- what the charity is and what they do
- what tasks you would like your friend to do to help.

Your friend's email address is j250@hotmail.com

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

To:	j250@hotmail.com
Cc:	
Subject:	

Hello Jake

I went down the boxing gym yesterday and Jeff was telling me that they might have to close because they dont have enuff money to keep going, he told me they was a charity and all th money they get is because people do funraisers and stuff like that. I wanna riase some money for them and fort we could do a sponsered silence, everyone knows that you is a right talker and you would fine it really hard so they is more likely to give you more money. What do you think. I will do it with you and may be we could raise a quite abit. We cpould do it at the gym an we would start at ten in the morning an every one would have there own desk and we would just sit there in silence for as long as we could take it. I am gonna ask people to sponsor me for every 20 minutes I keep silent. I dont know what we would do without the gym or where we would be

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – Borderline Script

now if we don't have it. Let me know what you think and we can organise it.

See you at the gym.

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length		✓			
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing			✓		
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language		✓			
Overall band	Band 3				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	11

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling			2			
Punctuation				1		
Grammar		3				
SPaG Total						6
SPaG mark + composition mark						17

Overall mark for question 2	17
Overall mark for question 1	15
FINAL MARK	32

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Commentary

Composition

The candidate has clearly addressed the task and has been able to communicate the message clearly and coherently. A significant omission of detail is the role that he would like his friend to undertake in helping to organise the day. Much of the formatting is present, although the subject line and sender's name are missing. The piece would also have benefitted from being split into paragraphs. As it is an email to a friend, the language choices are appropriately informal, although the candidate's use of *wanna* and *gonna* are penalised. The presence of comma splices suggests the candidate's control of sentence structures, including complex sentences, is not secure. However, the response is functional, and this is reflected in the overall award of a band 3 for composition.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling is correct some of the time, but there are numerous errors, including e*nough, the, fundraisers, raise, thought, sponsored, find, maybe, a bit, could, and, everyone*.

Punctuation is limited to capital letters and full stops to start and end sentences; however, there are some comma splices. In addition, the candidate has omitted several apostrophes in contractions, a question mark and several commas.

Grammar is largely correct, and there is good evidence of tense control, but there are several errors of subject-verb agreement.

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – fail

Question 1

You witnessed a minor accident where a cyclist crashed into a pedestrian who was crossing the road. No one was seriously hurt, but the cyclist and the pedestrian had an argument about whose fault it was, which ended up with the police being called.

As you witnessed the whole event, the police have asked you to provide written details of what you saw.

Your task: write the narrative (sequence of events) of what happened. Include the following detail:

- where and when the accident took place
- what happened to cause the accident
- whose fault you believe it was
- what happened during the argument.

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

I seen a cyclist crash in to this bloke on the road an he was walking an weren't looking where he is goin and step on the road and the rider crashed into him and it was bad and then tehy both get up and strated shouting and going at eachother saying it was eachothers fault when really it was jus an accident cos the pedestran werent looking and the cyclist wernt stopping . In the argument they just had a go at eachother and then the police came and sorted it all out.

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately			✓		
Writes text of appropriate detail and length				✓	
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing				✓	
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language				✓	
Overall band	Band 1				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	3

[DIAGNOSTIC]

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – fail

MFS Step 2: Diagnostic Pitfalls & Remediation Notes *Verified by Tutor Abdul*

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling				1		
Punctuation				1		
Grammar				1		
SPaG Total						3
SPaG mark + composition mark						6

Commentary

This response is very short, and the detail is very limited. Significant detail is missing, including when and where the accident occurred, specific details of the argument and the contact detail for the witness if there were to be any follow-up. Format and structure is also poor, with no attempt to make it look like an official document and no heading, subheadings or paragraphing to aid the reader and add coherence to the writing. The language is rather informal at times and the first sentence is clumsy and extremely long.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling errors are frequent and include *and, going, they, started, each other, just, because, pedestrian*. Some errors may be typing errors, but these are still taken into account when awarding marks.
Punctuation is poor. There is very little use of punctuation to provide the marker with sufficient evidence to be able to award marks with any confidence. The response consists of two sentences, and for one of those, the full stop has an additional space before it. In order to access higher marks for punctuation, candidates must demonstrate their use of punctuation marks that goes beyond sentence demarcation, to include commas to separate clauses, apostrophes to denote possession or contraction and the use of correct upper and lower case letters within sentences, for instance when using proper nouns.

Grammar is also poor, and errors include incorrect subject-verb agreement and incorrect verb-tense agreement. As the response consists of only two sentences, and both sentences contain errors, the evidence is very limited.

[DIAGNOSTIC]

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – fail

MFS Step 3: Diagnostic Pitfalls & Remediation Notes *Verified by Tutor Abdul*

Question 2

You would like to raise money for your favourite charity and have the idea of holding a sponsored silence for a whole afternoon.

Your task: write an email to a friend explaining your idea and asking them to help organise it.

Include the following detail:

- why you are writing
- what your idea is and how you think the event should be organised
- what the charity is and what they do
- what tasks you would like your friend to do to help.

Your friend's email address is j250@hotmail.com

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

To:	j250@hotmail.com
Cc:	
Subject:	

I am writting becasue I have got an idea about a funraser. My idea is to do a sponsor silence at collage and we could rase money for charity. We can just be quite for the hole day and people will give us there money at the end and we can give it to charity. The charity is help for heros and they look after soldjurs after they have been to war and get injured. The tasks I would like you to do is to get sponsers and do the sponser silence.

john

[DIAGNOSTIC]

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – fail

MFS Step 4: Diagnostic Pitfalls & Remediation Notes *Verified by Tutor Abdul*

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately			✓		
Writes text of appropriate detail and length				✓	
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing				✓	
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language			✓		
Overall band	Band 2				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	4

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling			2			
Punctuation				1		
Grammar			2			
SPaG Total						5
SPaG mark + composition mark						9

Overall mark for question 2	9
Overall mark for question 1	6
FINAL MARK	15

Commentary

Composition

This response lacks detail and coherence. The candidate has attempted to address the bullet points provided in the brief, but they have done so without particular consideration of the task and how to create a coherent piece of writing that flows from one point to the other. Detail is sparse and the length is short despite the suggested word count of between 200 and 250 words. The subject line has not been completed, and the opening salutation and valediction have been omitted.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

[DIAGNOSTIC]

Sample Paper 2 Level 1 Worked Example – fail

MFS Step 5: Diagnostic Pitfalls & Remediation Notes *Verified by Tutor Abdul*

Spelling errors are frequent and there are very few ambitious words, if any, that have been spelt correctly.

Punctuation is limited to capital letters to start a sentence and full stops to end them.

There are few grammar errors, but the brevity of the response is taken into account when allocating marks.

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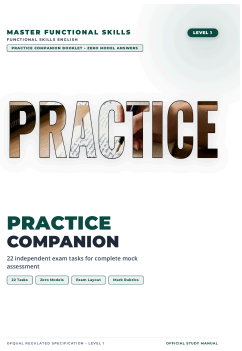


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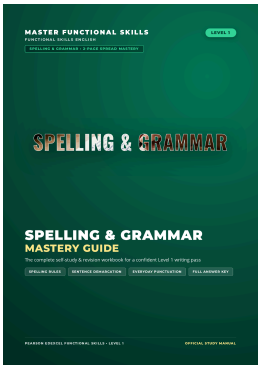


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